Interactional DNA

How to turn everyday calls into owned intelligence

You can build conversational intelligence. You can buy conversational intelligence. You still miss the move that would have changed the outcome.

A short field guide for teams building or buying conversation intelligence tools, on how to capture repeatable behavioral moves from recorded calls and store them as owned assets.

The thing conversation intelligence still doesn't keep

Most conversation intelligence setups are good at storage and recall. Record the call, transcribe it, summarize it, tag it, search it later.

That's useful. It's also why so many teams feel like they have "insight" and still get the same outcomes.

> **Concrete scene:** A customer calls for the third time. They open with: "I've called twice. I'm done repeating myself. Fix it today."

The system captures: transcript, summary, tags like "angry," "urgent," "repeat contact" — maybe a score.

The business still loses when the agent makes a vague commitment, the customer escalates, and the next team inherits a mess.

What got missed was the move that prevents escalation in that moment.

Conversation intelligence often stores the story. It rarely stores the intervention. And that's the gap this ebook is about.

What Interactional DNA means when you build or buy these tools

Interactional DNA is the **repeatable behavioral move** inside a call that reliably changes an outcome.

A move counts as Interactional DNA only if it is:

- observable in the audio and the transcript
- tied to a decision or action
- teachable so another human can run it tomorrow

What is *not* Interactional DNA

- transcripts and summaries by themselves
- generic coaching like "be more empathetic"
- sentiment labels without a linked behavior change
- call scoring without "what to do instead" at the moment that mattered

Examples of DNA moves a CI tool usually misses

- the "define done" move that turns "fix it today" into a workable outcome
- the "repair" move that breaks a repeat loop when the customer says "I already told you"
- the "no promise" move that prevents a policy breach while keeping trust intact
- the escalation handoff move that transfers the full context without tone damage

> If your tool cannot capture moves like these as reusable assets, it becomes a reporting layer, not an outcome layer.

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Why current CI approaches still feel inadequate

Most CI systems ship these outputs: transcript, summary, topics, sentiment, talk ratios, scorecards, dashboards.

Those outputs answer: **"What happened."** They rarely answer: **"What should happen next time, in the next 30 seconds."**

Where it breaks

Escalations and deal losses are rarely caused by one big mistake. They are caused by micro-moments:

- one missed definition of done
- one wrong promise
- one missed repair move
- one timing mistake that makes the other person feel dismissed
- one handoff detail that gets lost

Summaries compress away micro-moments. Scores label them. Neither stores the move you need to run next time.

The trade-off CI vendors often accept without saying it out loud

They optimise for **breadth**: cover every call, tag everything, show trends. They sacrifice **depth**: capture the actual behavior unit that changed the outcome.

That's why teams can buy CI, increase review activity, and still see repeat escalations and repeat losses.

The extraction method that converts CI into owned intelligence

This method works whether you are building a CI tool or buying one. It's also fast enough to run weekly.

DNA capture in 90 seconds

After reviewing a call segment, capture only five fields:

1. **Turning point moment** — the exact moment the call moved toward calm or toward escalation
2. **Move executed right before it** — what the agent did, not what they intended
3. **Constraint locked or clarified** — what got defined that changed the next step
4. **Risk avoided** — wrong promise avoided, wrong action avoided, escalation avoided
5. **Two lines of exact phrasing** — just two lines, no paragraphs

> **Edge case rule:** The best DNA comes from messy calls: interruptions, repeat contacts, anger, ambiguity, policy boundaries. Clean calls are easier to tag, but they teach less.

Move naming rule: Verb + object + condition

- "Define done when urgency is demanded"
- "Break repeat loop when customer restates complaint"
- "Refuse promise when policy boundary is hit"
- "Escalate with context when trust is damaged"

This creates a shared language across teams and makes moves storable.

What "owned intelligence" looks like for CI buyers and builders

Owned intelligence is not another dashboard. It is a **library of moves that survives people churn and tool churn.**

You need three assets.

Asset 1 — Move Card

- move name · when to use · what it prevents
- two lines of phrasing
- what must be captured as evidence

Asset 2 — Embed Point

Where this move becomes consistent: required field in CRM or ticket, recap template, support macro, QA checklist, manager inspection prompt.

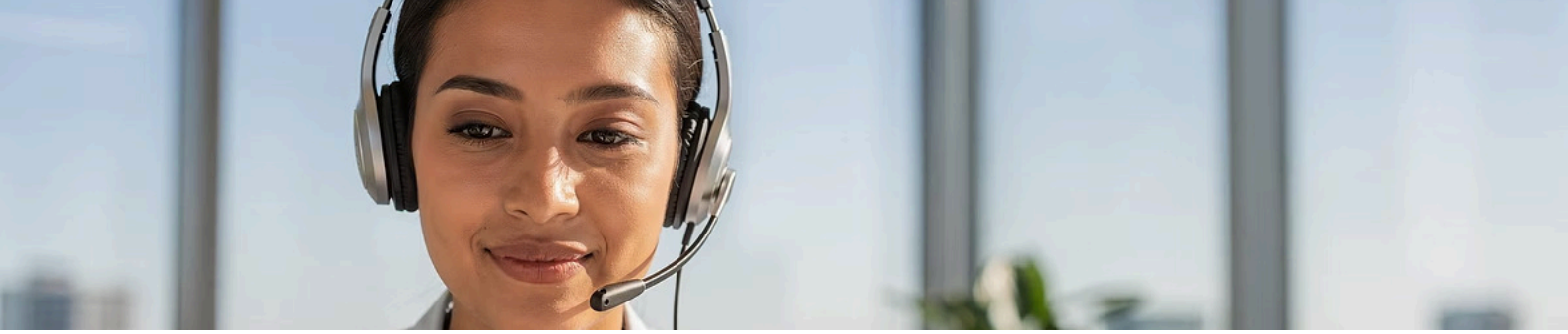
> If you don't embed it, the move stays optional, and optional moves do not change outcomes.

Asset 3 — Evidence Snippet

- the two lines that were said
- when it was said
- what changed immediately after

Evidence snippets are what turn coaching from opinion into repeatable practice.

For **builders**: this is the missing product layer — move capture, move packaging, and workflow embedding, not just analytics. For **buyers**: this is the missing operating layer — how to turn what you recorded into a reusable system.



Worked example that a CI system can learn from

> "I've called twice. I'm done repeating myself. Fix it today."

Many tools will tag this as: angry · urgent · repeat contact. That helps reporting. It doesn't solve the call.

What a top agent does: They stop troubleshooting for 20 seconds and lock "done today" into something real, before any promise is made.

DNA capture (filled)

1. **Turning point moment** — right after "fix it today," before the agent starts steps
2. **Move executed** — define done and lock the constraint before actioning
3. **Constraint locked** — what "fixed today" means by end of day
4. **Risk avoided** — vague promise that would fail and trigger escalation later
5. **Two lines of exact phrasing** — "When you say 'fixed today,' what does that look like by end of day. Full resolution or a workaround you can use today." / "I'll aim for that outcome first. If it's not possible, I'll tell you early."

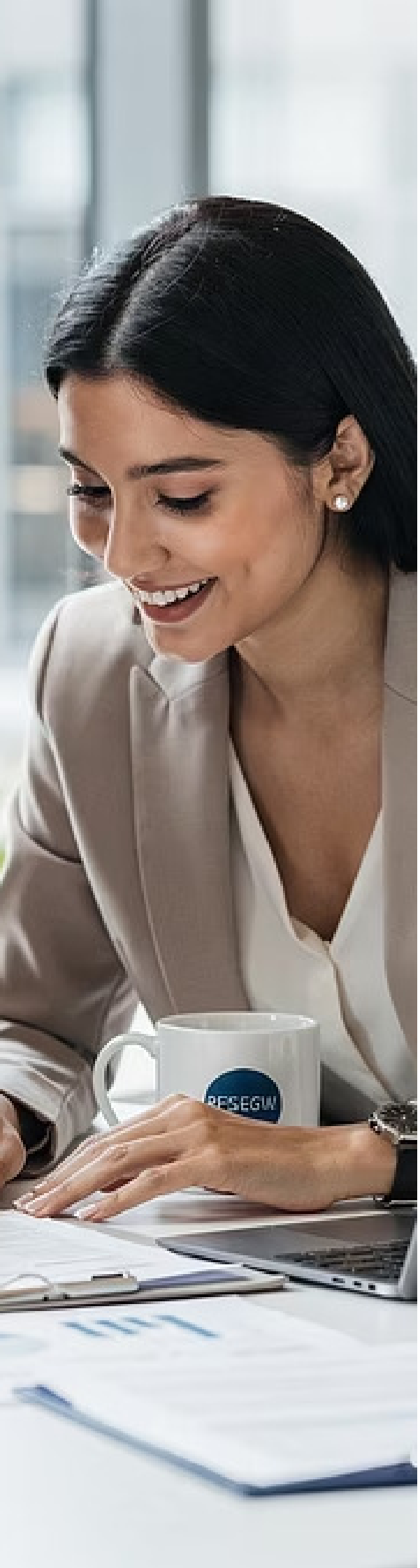
Move Card created

Move name: Define done when urgency is demanded
When to use: Urgency language, especially after repeat contacts
What it prevents: Vague commitments that become escalations

Embed point examples

- ticket field: definition of done
- QA check: was definition of done captured before steps
- manager inspection: show the field and the phrasing

This is how CI becomes owned intelligence: capture the move, store it, embed it.



Keep it alive without turning it into busywork

CI programmes stall when the tool becomes the work. Interactional DNA compounds only when it is treated like a library that is maintained.

Minimum loop

Weekly

- pick 5 messy calls
- extract 5 moves
- create 5 move cards with evidence snippets
- embed one move into a field or checklist

Monthly

- retire moves that no longer match policy or product
- update embed points so adoption is inspectable

Ongoing

- managers inspect embed points, not vibes
- QA reviews whether the move ran at the moment that mattered

This keeps CI from becoming "more analysis, same outcomes."

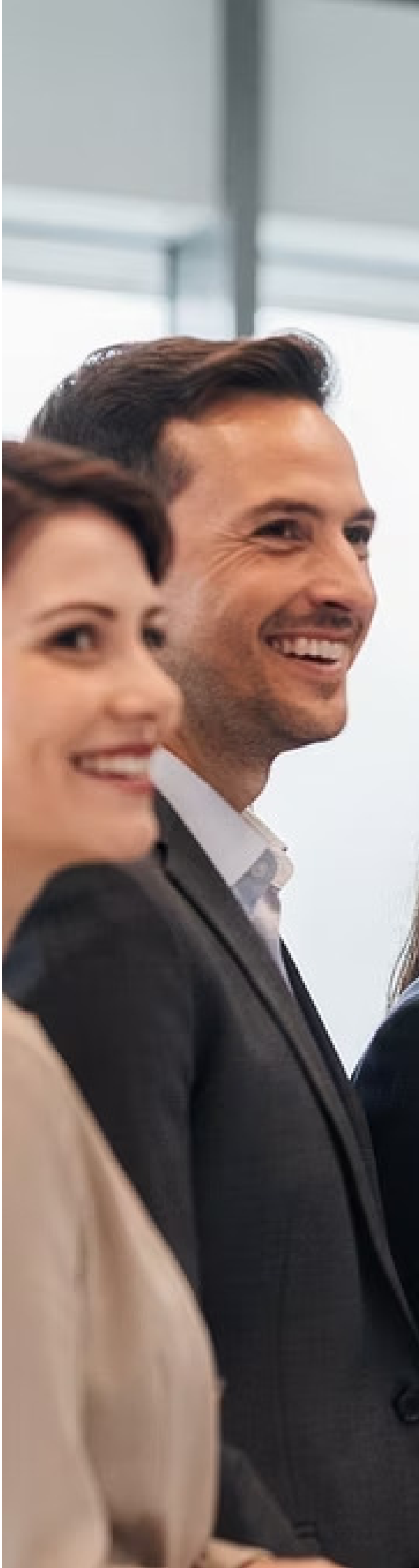
Close the gap. Own the moves.

If you build or buy conversation intelligence and stop at transcripts, summaries, and dashboards, the failure curve looks like this:

- You detect patterns after the damage
- You score calls without storing interventions
- Top performers stay top because only they carry the moves
- Everyone else learns slowly because training stays conceptual
- Escalations and churn keep repeating because the company forgets the fix after each call

Interactional DNA closes that gap. It turns recorded calls into owned assets that change what humans do next time.

Risk elimination steps

1. **Eliminate "dashboard-only" adoption risk** — We turn your recordings into a move library with evidence and embed points, so CI drives behaviour change instead of becoming reporting.
2. **Eliminate escalation repeat loops from repeat-contact calls** — We extract and embed the repair and definition-of-done moves that stop escalation in the first 60 seconds.
3. **Eliminate vendor dependency for learning** — We help you build an owned Interactional DNA library that survives tool churn, manager churn, and team growth.

> **What is the one move your best agent uses in high-pressure calls that your CI system cannot currently store as a reusable asset?**
>
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